

Brand Naming Workbook

Generation to Trademark

Naming fails when teams fall in love before checking availability. This workbook front-loads screening so you only develop names you can actually own.

What's inside

- Six name generation techniques
- Screening scorecard
- Linguistic and cultural checks
- Domain and trademark search order
- Shortlist testing method

Generation

- 01 Descriptive, evocative, invented, lexical, acronym, founder
- 02 Generate 100 candidates before evaluating any
- 03 Separate generation from judgement — different sessions
- 04 Include the obvious names to get them out of the system

Screening

- 01 Say it aloud — ambiguity in speech is disqualifying
- 02 Spell it over the phone without explanation
- 03 Check length and how it reads in lowercase
- 04 Ensure it does not box you into one product line

Availability

- 01 Search trademarks in every market you plan to enter
- 02 Check exact-match domain and reasonable alternatives
- 03 Verify social handles across the platforms you will use
- 04 Search for existing companies with confusable names

Validation

- 01 Test the shortlist with real target customers
- 02 Ask what they expect the company to do, unprompted
- 03 Check for unintended meanings in relevant languages
- 04 Choose on strategic fit, not internal popularity vote

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